

PROGRESSIVE STEPS TO

SYNCO-PATION

FOR THE MODERN DRUMMER

BY
TED REED



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Foreword

In every band or ensemble, the drummer is called upon to give that group a solid rhythmic foundation. Therefore it is important that every drummer have excellent music reading skills. The goal of this book is to first introduce basic music reading skills and then to explore many of the most common syncopation rhythms found in today's music.

Here are some suggestions on how to practice the rhythms and exercises found in this book:

1. Count out loud. This is a "must" in order to become a good reader.
2. Practice at various tempos from slow to fast.
3. Work on incorporating the syncopated rhythms you learn in this book around the full drumset (toms, cymbals, hi-hat, etc.).
4. Devote some of your practice time to playing with a metronome.

Remember, there is no substitute for a good teacher.

Since its publication, many drummers have asked me how I was inspired to write *Progressive Steps to Syncopation for the Modern Drummer*.

I was teaching drums at the Hartnett Music School, located at 1585 Broadway in New York City. I gave 85 half-hour lessons each week and had approximately 55 students (some took two lessons a week). I taught Monday through Friday, 9:00 a.m. to 2:00 p.m. and 6:00 p.m. to 10:00 p.m. In each half-hour lesson, I would listen to the student's last lesson and then write, demonstrate, explain and play with them on their new lesson. Since I could not find any books on syncopation, each lesson had to be written out individually.

When I would get home at night, my hands and arms would ache as a result of having to do so much writing. It was then that I decided to write the lessons out on manuscript paper. I wrote every night from midnight to 4:00 a.m., until I had a total of 60 pages. I had 200 copies of each page printed, which enabled me to hand whatever page was needed to a student—no more writing out each lesson every time.

I was careful to protect my original work from plagiarism until I received an official copyright from the Bureau of Copyrights in Washington, D.C. I had it published in 1958, and the book has sold very well ever since. Thanks to many teachers and drummers it is now one of the most popular drum books ever written.

Ted Reed

Note-Reading Rhythms/Exercises

Lesson One

Playing quarter notes, quarter rests and half rests.

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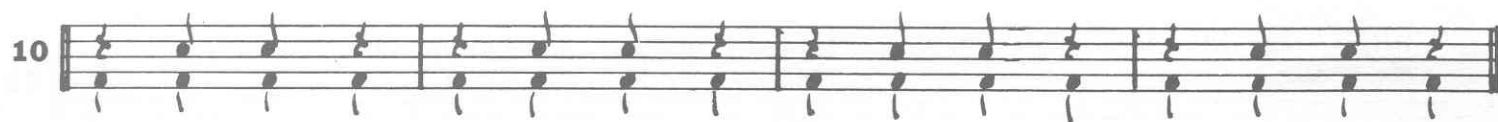
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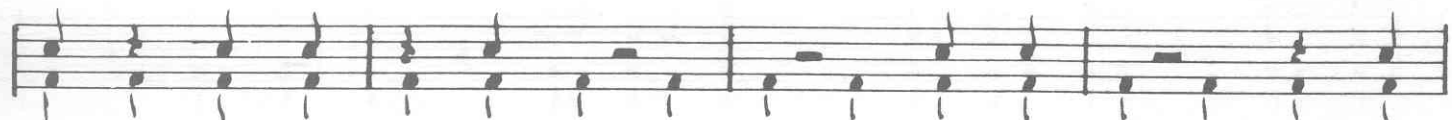
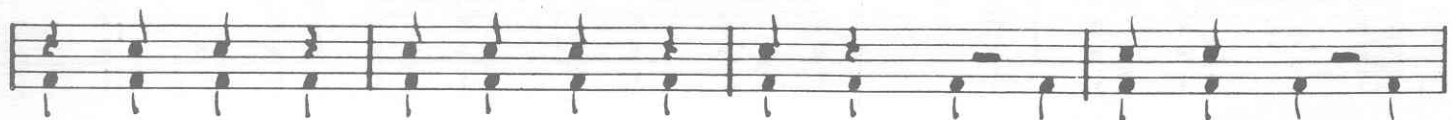
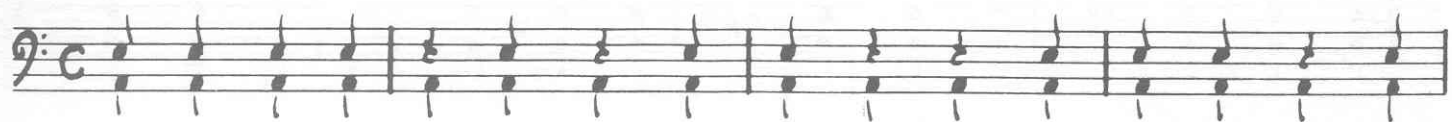
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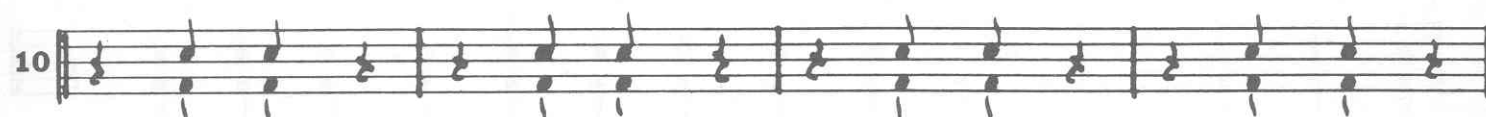
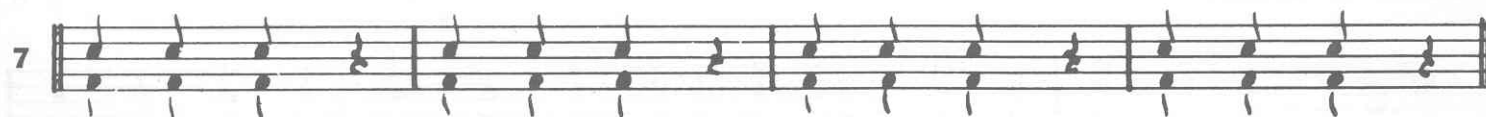
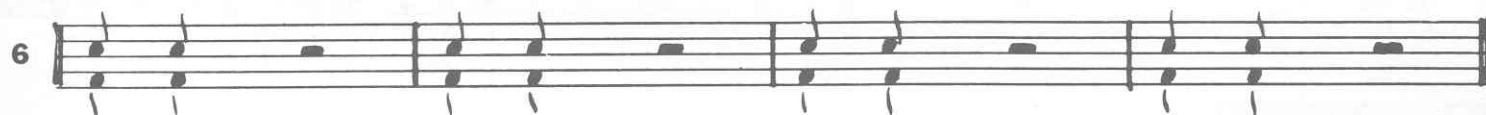
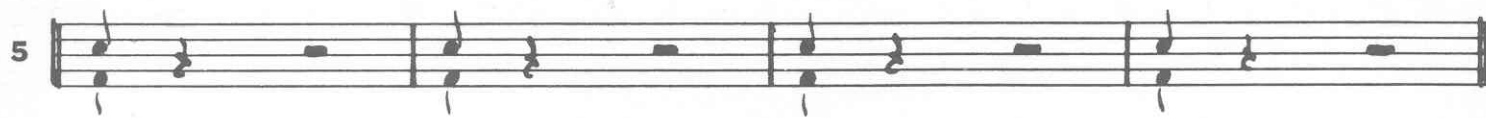


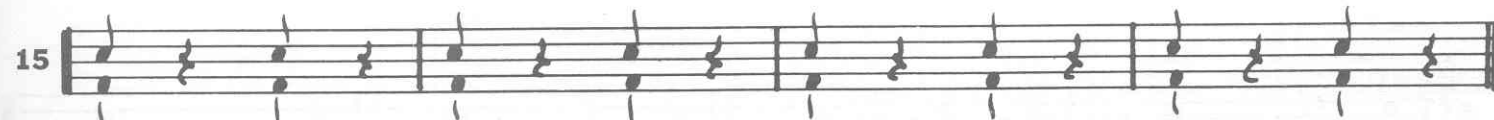
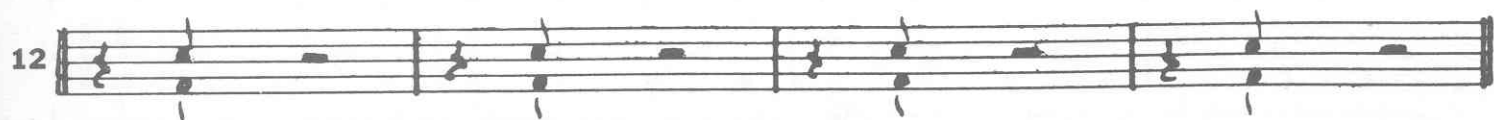
16-Bar Exercise



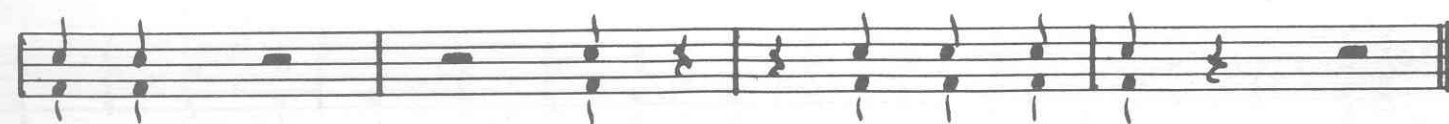
Lesson Two

Playing quarter notes, quarter rests and half rests in unison.





16-Bar Exercise



Lesson Three

Playing quarter notes, quarter rests and half rests independently.

10 exercises for independent playing of quarter notes, quarter rests, and half rests.

Exercise 1: Bass clef, common time (C). The exercise consists of four measures, each containing a half note followed by a quarter note, then a quarter rest followed by a half note, and finally a quarter note followed by a quarter rest.

Exercise 2: Treble clef, common time (C). The exercise consists of four measures, each containing a half note followed by a quarter note, then a quarter rest followed by a half note, and finally a quarter note followed by a quarter rest.

Exercise 3: Treble clef, common time (C). The exercise consists of four measures, each containing a half note followed by a quarter note, then a quarter rest followed by a half note, and finally a quarter note followed by a quarter rest.

Exercise 4: Treble clef, common time (C). The exercise consists of four measures, each containing a half note followed by a quarter note, then a quarter rest followed by a half note, and finally a quarter note followed by a quarter rest.

Exercise 5: Treble clef, common time (C). The exercise consists of four measures, each containing a half note followed by a quarter note, then a quarter rest followed by a half note, and finally a quarter note followed by a quarter rest.

Exercise 6: Treble clef, common time (C). The exercise consists of four measures, each containing a half note followed by a quarter note, then a quarter rest followed by a half note, and finally a quarter note followed by a quarter rest.

Exercise 7: Treble clef, common time (C). The exercise consists of four measures, each containing a half note followed by a quarter note, then a quarter rest followed by a half note, and finally a quarter note followed by a quarter rest.

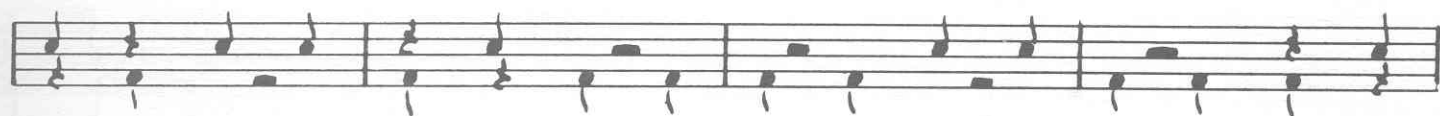
Exercise 8: Treble clef, common time (C). The exercise consists of four measures, each containing a half note followed by a quarter note, then a quarter rest followed by a half note, and finally a quarter note followed by a quarter rest.

Exercise 9: Treble clef, common time (C). The exercise consists of four measures, each containing a half note followed by a quarter note, then a quarter rest followed by a half note, and finally a quarter note followed by a quarter rest.

Exercise 10: Treble clef, common time (C). The exercise consists of four measures, each containing a half note followed by a quarter note, then a quarter rest followed by a half note, and finally a quarter note followed by a quarter rest.



16-Bar Exercise



Lesson Four

Playing eighth notes and quarter notes.

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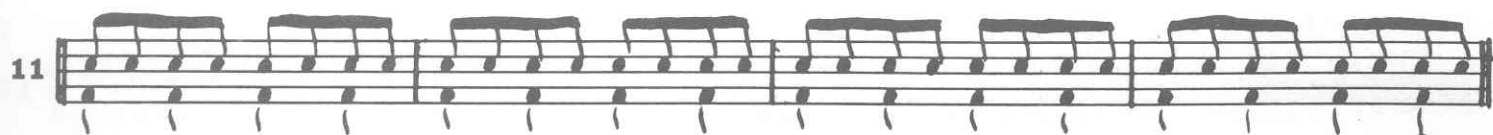
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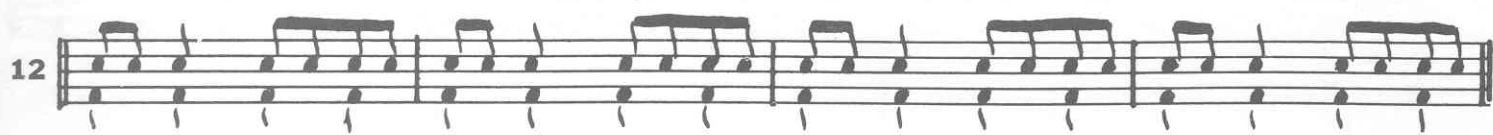
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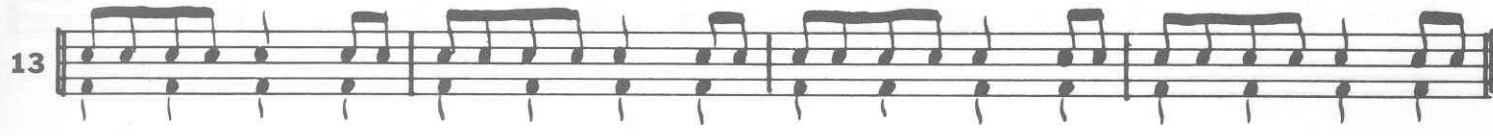
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The image displays ten staves of musical notation, numbered 1 through 10. Each staff contains four measures of music. The notation is written on a five-line staff with a treble clef and a common time signature (C). The notes are primarily eighth notes and quarter notes, often grouped in pairs or fours with beams. The rhythm is consistent across all staves, with a steady eighth-note pulse in the right hand and quarter-note accompaniment in the left hand. The notes are mostly black, indicating they are in the key of C major or F minor.

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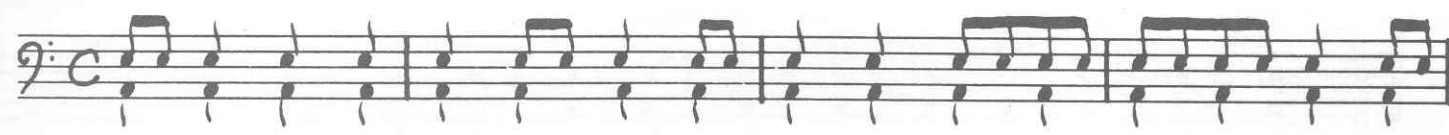
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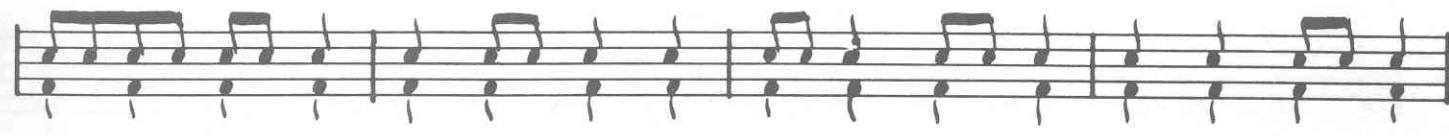
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20-Bar Exercise





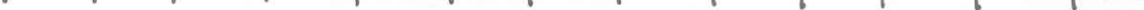


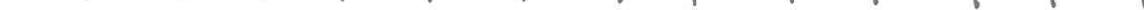




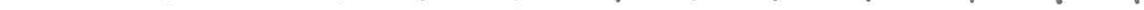
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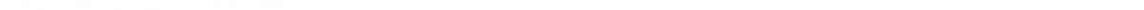
Musical notation for the first system of 'The Little Boat'. It features a treble clef, a key signature of one flat (B-flat), and a common time signature (C). The melody is written on a five-line staff, and the bass line is written on a four-line staff. The melody consists of a series of eighth and sixteenth notes, with a final measure ending in a double bar line.

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20-Bar Exercise











Lesson Six

Playing eighth-note triplets and quarter notes.

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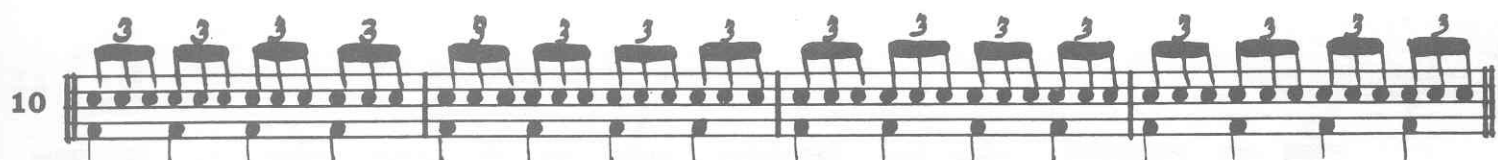
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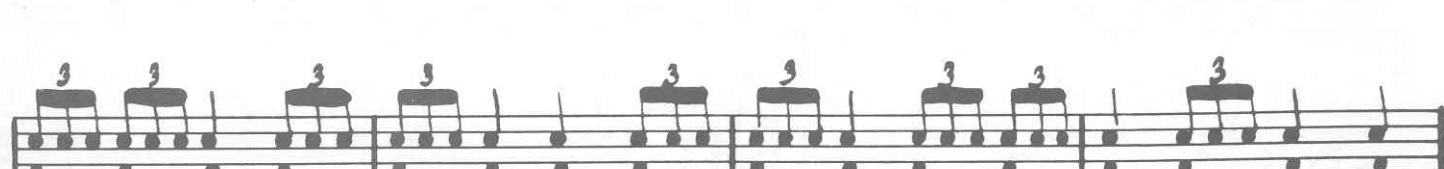
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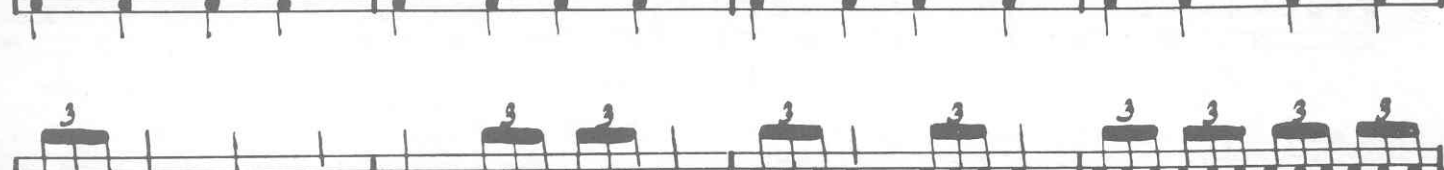
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16-Bar Exercise









Lesson Seven

Playing eighth-note triplets, eighth notes and quarter notes.

The image displays ten staves of musical notation, numbered 1 through 10 on the left. Each staff contains four measures of music. The notation includes eighth-note triplets (indicated by a '3' above the notes), eighth notes, and quarter notes. The first staff (1) begins with a treble clef and a 4/4 time signature. The music is written in a single melodic line on a five-line staff, with a bass line of quarter notes provided below. The patterns of eighth-note triplets and eighth notes vary across the staves, providing a progressive exercise for the student.

The musical score for 'The Merry-Go-Round' is presented in five systems, numbered 11 through 15. Each system consists of a single staff with a treble clef and a key signature of one flat (B-flat). The music is written in 2/4 time. The notation includes eighth and sixteenth notes, often beamed together in groups of three or four, indicating triplets and sixteenth-note patterns. The score is divided into measures by vertical bar lines, and each system concludes with a double bar line. The overall structure is a continuous melody with a steady rhythmic pattern.

16-Bar Exercise

The image displays a musical score for a piece titled "The Merry Widow". The score is written for a single melodic line on a five-line staff, using a treble clef and a key signature of one flat (B-flat). The time signature is 3/4, indicated by a '3' over a '4'. The music is organized into four measures, each separated by a vertical bar line. The first measure contains a triplet of eighth notes, followed by a quarter note, and then another triplet of eighth notes. The second measure begins with a quarter note, followed by a triplet of eighth notes, and then a quarter note. The third measure starts with a quarter note, followed by a triplet of eighth notes, and then a quarter note. The fourth measure begins with a quarter note, followed by a triplet of eighth notes, and then a quarter note. The score is presented in a clear, black-and-white format, typical of a printed musical manuscript.

Lesson Eight

Playing eighth-note triplets and dotted eighth/sixteenth notes.

10 exercises for playing eighth-note triplets and dotted eighth/sixteenth notes. Each exercise is written on a single staff with a treble clef and a 4/4 time signature. The exercises are numbered 1 through 10 on the left side of the page.

Exercise 1: Four measures of eighth-note triplets. Each measure contains a triplet of eighth notes, followed by a dotted quarter note and an eighth note.

Exercise 2: Four measures of eighth-note triplets. Each measure contains a triplet of eighth notes, followed by a dotted quarter note and an eighth note.

Exercise 3: Four measures of eighth-note triplets. Each measure contains a triplet of eighth notes, followed by a dotted quarter note and an eighth note.

Exercise 4: Four measures of eighth-note triplets. Each measure contains a triplet of eighth notes, followed by a dotted quarter note and an eighth note.

Exercise 5: Four measures of eighth-note triplets. Each measure contains a triplet of eighth notes, followed by a dotted quarter note and an eighth note.

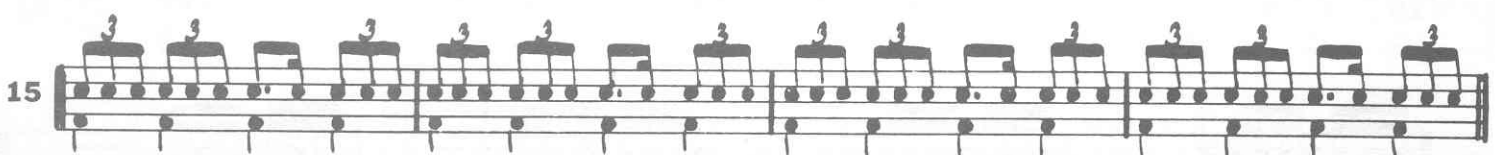
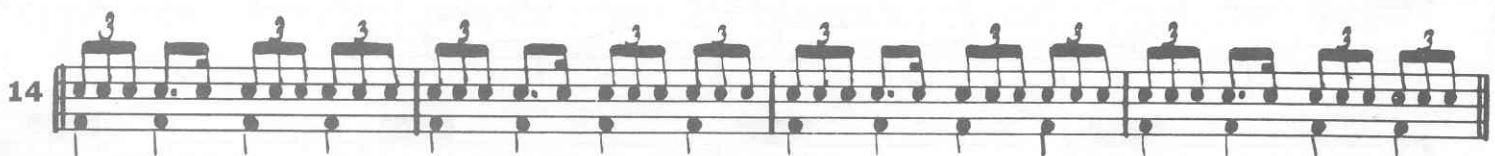
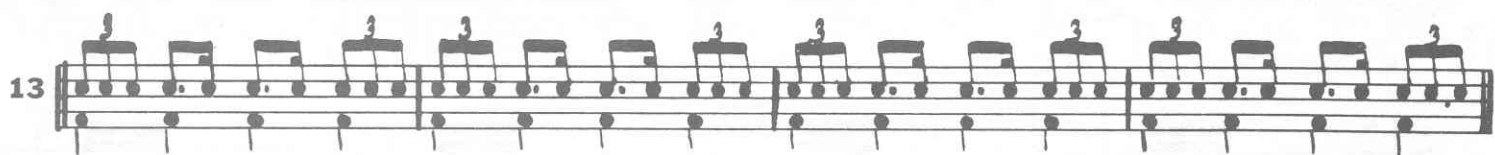
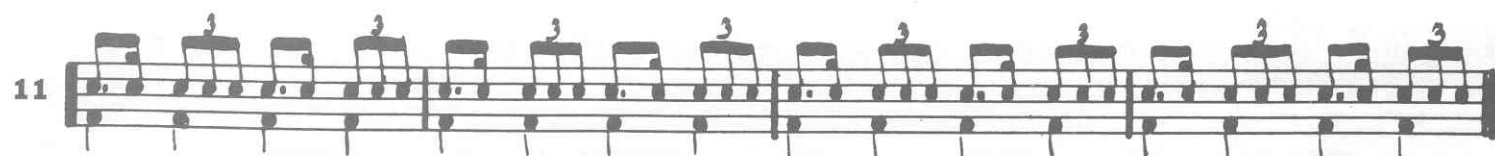
Exercise 6: Four measures of eighth-note triplets. Each measure contains a triplet of eighth notes, followed by a dotted quarter note and an eighth note.

Exercise 7: Four measures of eighth-note triplets. Each measure contains a triplet of eighth notes, followed by a dotted quarter note and an eighth note.

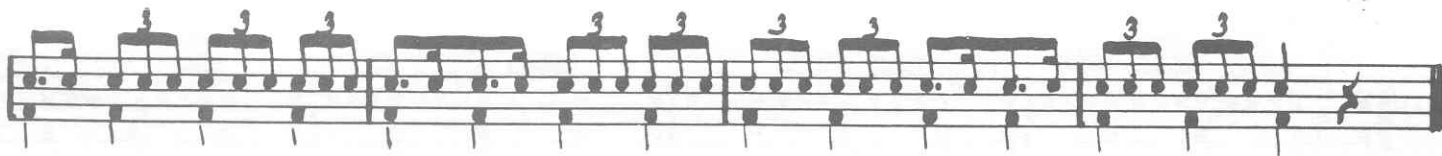
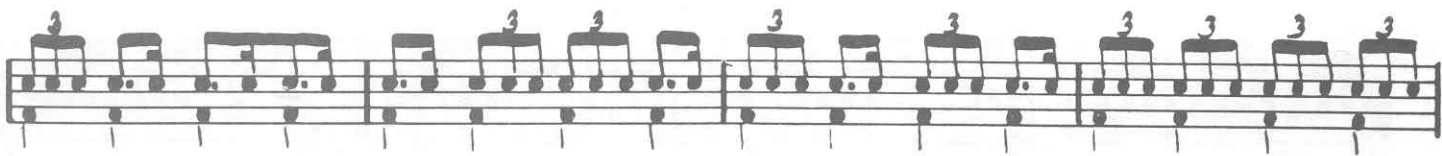
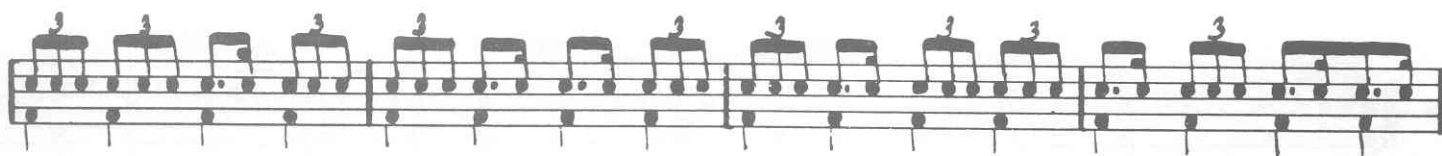
Exercise 8: Four measures of eighth-note triplets. Each measure contains a triplet of eighth notes, followed by a dotted quarter note and an eighth note.

Exercise 9: Four measures of eighth-note triplets. Each measure contains a triplet of eighth notes, followed by a dotted quarter note and an eighth note.

Exercise 10: Four measures of eighth-note triplets. Each measure contains a triplet of eighth notes, followed by a dotted quarter note and an eighth note.



16-Bar Exercise



Lesson Nine

Playing sixteenth notes and quarter notes.

10 exercises for playing sixteenth notes and quarter notes, numbered 1 through 10. Each exercise is written on a five-line staff with a treble clef and a 4/4 time signature. The exercises progress from simple quarter notes to complex sixteenth-note patterns.

Exercise 1: A single quarter note on G4, followed by a quarter rest, then a quarter note on A4, followed by a quarter rest, and so on, alternating between G4 and A4 for the first four measures.

Exercise 2: A single quarter note on G4, followed by a quarter rest, then a quarter note on A4, followed by a quarter rest, and so on, alternating between G4 and A4 for the first four measures.

Exercise 3: A single quarter note on G4, followed by a quarter rest, then a quarter note on A4, followed by a quarter rest, and so on, alternating between G4 and A4 for the first four measures.

Exercise 4: A single quarter note on G4, followed by a quarter rest, then a quarter note on A4, followed by a quarter rest, and so on, alternating between G4 and A4 for the first four measures.

Exercise 5: A single quarter note on G4, followed by a quarter rest, then a quarter note on A4, followed by a quarter rest, and so on, alternating between G4 and A4 for the first four measures.

Exercise 6: A single quarter note on G4, followed by a quarter rest, then a quarter note on A4, followed by a quarter rest, and so on, alternating between G4 and A4 for the first four measures.

Exercise 7: A single quarter note on G4, followed by a quarter rest, then a quarter note on A4, followed by a quarter rest, and so on, alternating between G4 and A4 for the first four measures.

Exercise 8: A single quarter note on G4, followed by a quarter rest, then a quarter note on A4, followed by a quarter rest, and so on, alternating between G4 and A4 for the first four measures.

Exercise 9: A single quarter note on G4, followed by a quarter rest, then a quarter note on A4, followed by a quarter rest, and so on, alternating between G4 and A4 for the first four measures.

Exercise 10: A single quarter note on G4, followed by a quarter rest, then a quarter note on A4, followed by a quarter rest, and so on, alternating between G4 and A4 for the first four measures.

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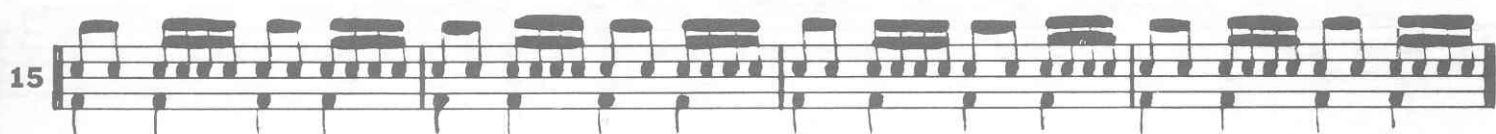
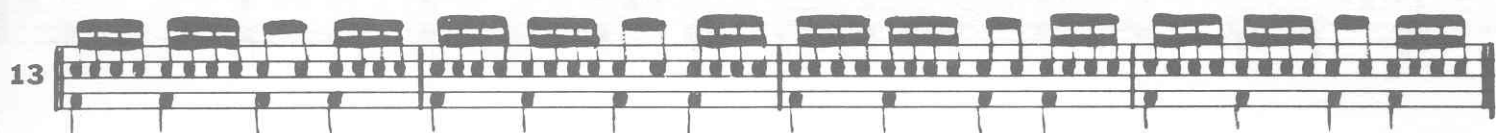
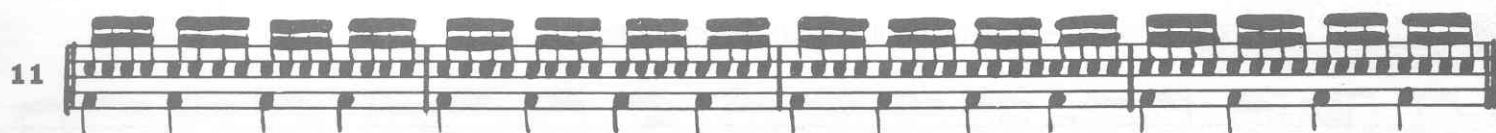
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20-Bar Exercise

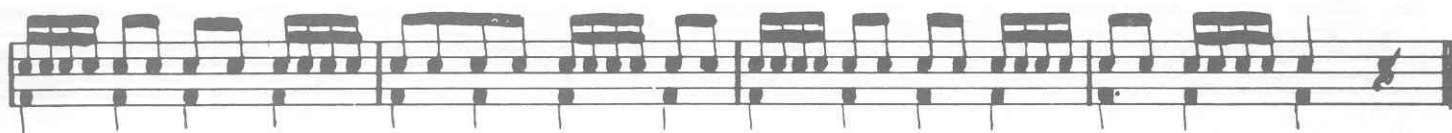
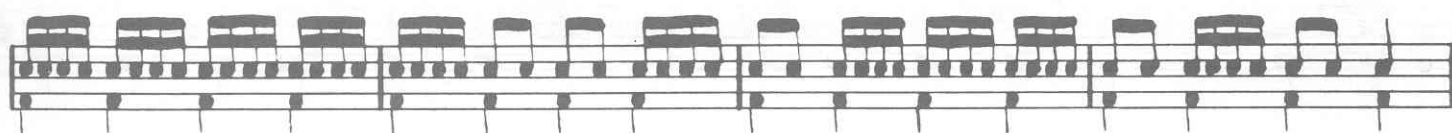
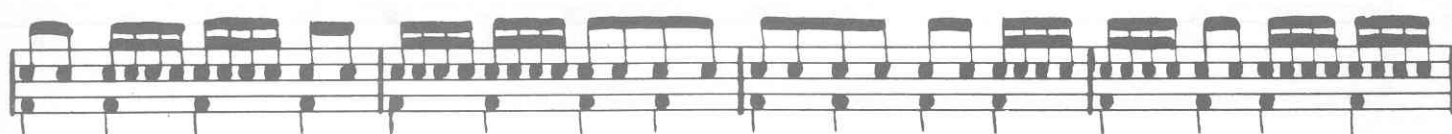
Lesson Ten

Playing sixteenth notes and eighth notes.

The image displays ten staves of musical notation, numbered 1 through 10 on the left. Each staff contains a sequence of notes and rests, primarily using sixteenth and eighth notes. The notation is arranged in a standard musical format with a treble clef and a key signature of one flat (B-flat). The exercises progress from simple eighth-note patterns in the first staff to more complex sixteenth-note runs in the tenth staff. The notes are written in a clear, black ink on a white background, with a consistent rhythm throughout the exercises.

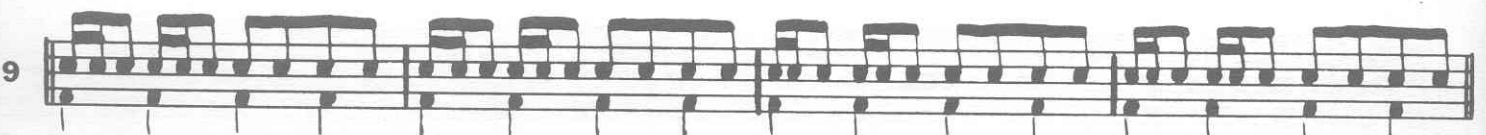
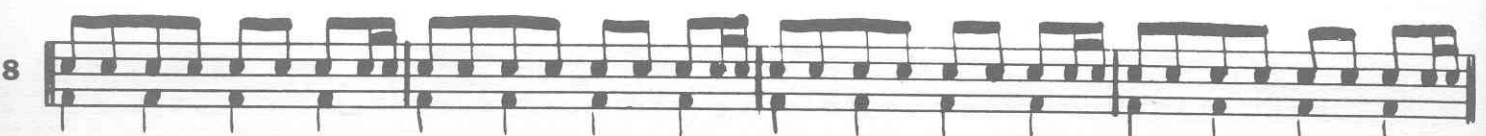
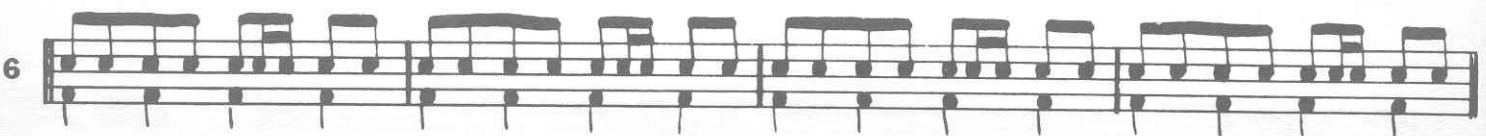
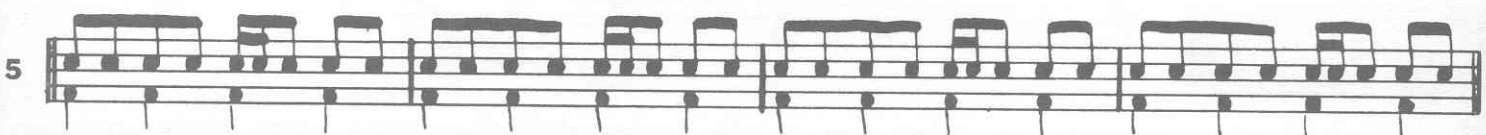
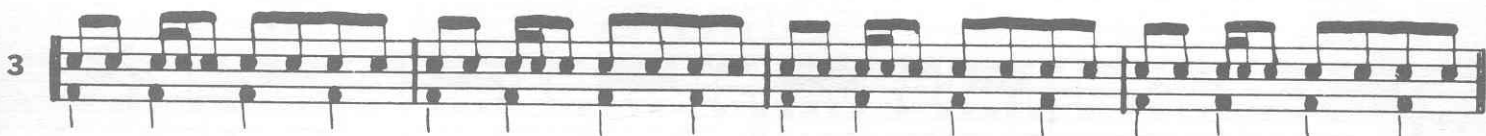
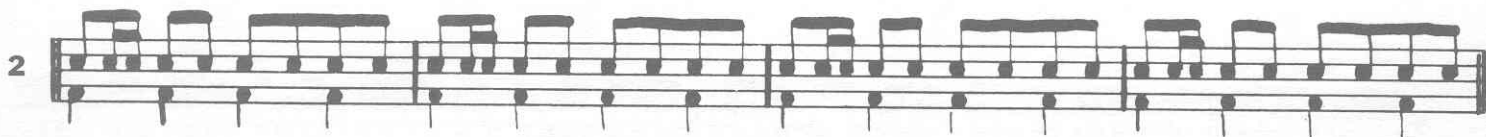


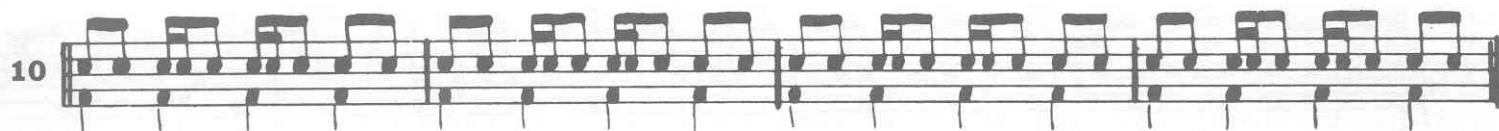
20-Bar Exercise

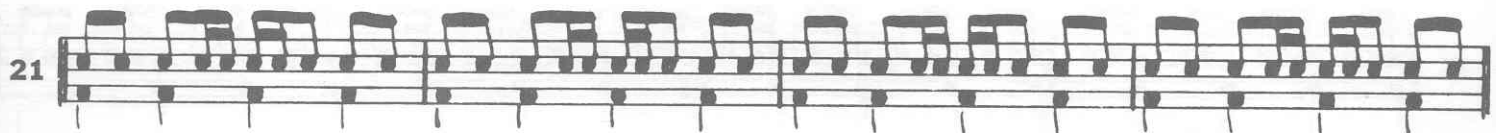
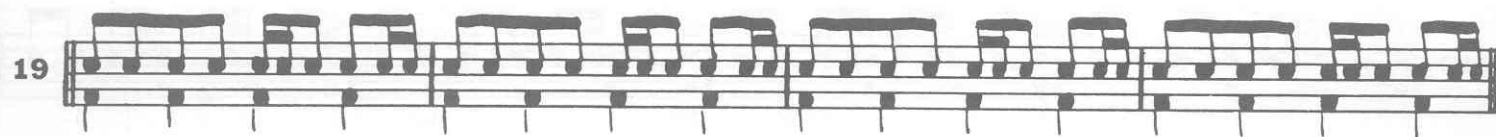


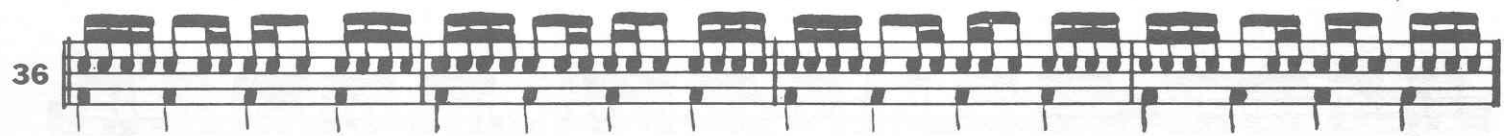
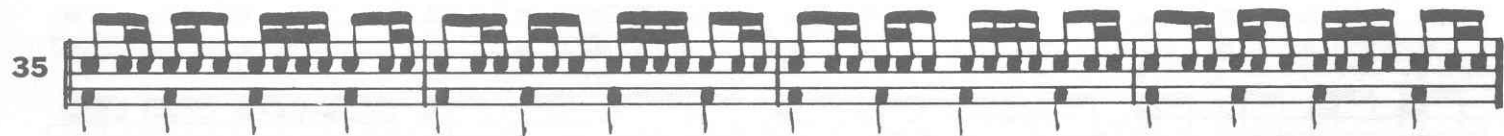
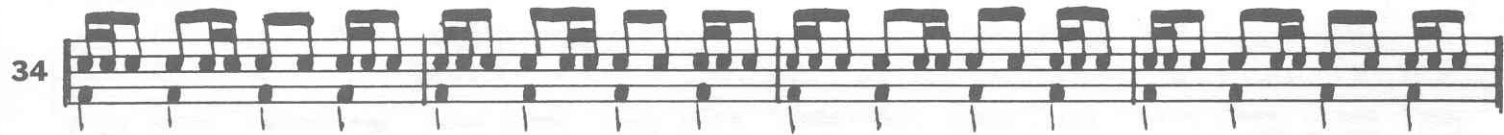
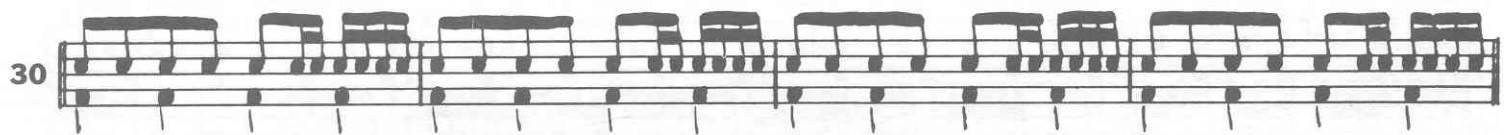
Lesson Eleven

Playing sixteenth notes and eighth notes.









40-Bar Exercise

This musical exercise is written for a single system with a treble and bass staff. The key signature is one sharp (F#), indicating G major, and the time signature is common time (C). The exercise consists of 40 measures, organized into 10 groups of 4 measures each. The melody in the treble staff is a continuous eighth-note line, starting on G4 and ascending stepwise to D5, then descending back to G4. The bass staff provides a steady accompaniment of quarter notes, starting on G2 and ascending stepwise to D3, then descending back to G2. The exercise concludes with a double bar line and a repeat sign.

48-Bar Exercise

This musical score is a 48-bar exercise in bass clef, common time (C). It is written on ten staves, each containing two five-line staves. The exercise begins with a treble clef and a common time signature. The first staff contains a single eighth note G2, followed by a series of eighth notes and quarter notes. The subsequent staves feature a variety of rhythmic patterns, including eighth notes, quarter notes, and sixteenth notes, often grouped in beams. The exercise concludes with a double bar line and a repeat sign.

Lesson TwelvePlaying eighth notes, eighth rests and quarter notes. *corchess s/y c/swing*

This musical exercise consists of 12 measures, each containing a pair of staves (treble and bass clef). The time signature is 4/4. The exercise is designed to practice eighth notes, eighth rests, and quarter notes. The notation is as follows:

- Measure 1:** Treble clef has a quarter rest, eighth rest, eighth note, and quarter note. Bass clef has a quarter note, eighth note, eighth rest, and quarter note.
- Measure 2:** Treble clef has a quarter note, eighth note, eighth rest, and quarter note. Bass clef has a quarter rest, eighth rest, eighth note, and quarter note.
- Measure 3:** Treble clef has a quarter note, eighth note, eighth rest, and quarter note. Bass clef has a quarter note, eighth note, eighth rest, and quarter note.
- Measure 4:** Treble clef has a quarter note, eighth note, eighth rest, and quarter note. Bass clef has a quarter note, eighth note, eighth rest, and quarter note.
- Measure 5:** Treble clef has a quarter note, eighth note, eighth rest, and quarter note. Bass clef has a quarter note, eighth note, eighth rest, and quarter note.
- Measure 6:** Treble clef has a quarter note, eighth note, eighth rest, and quarter note. Bass clef has a quarter note, eighth note, eighth rest, and quarter note.
- Measure 7:** Treble clef has a quarter note, eighth note, eighth rest, and quarter note. Bass clef has a quarter note, eighth note, eighth rest, and quarter note.
- Measure 8:** Treble clef has a quarter note, eighth note, eighth rest, and quarter note. Bass clef has a quarter note, eighth note, eighth rest, and quarter note.
- Measure 9:** Treble clef has a quarter note, eighth note, eighth rest, and quarter note. Bass clef has a quarter note, eighth note, eighth rest, and quarter note.
- Measure 10:** Treble clef has a quarter note, eighth note, eighth rest, and quarter note. Bass clef has a quarter note, eighth note, eighth rest, and quarter note.
- Measure 11:** Treble clef has a quarter note, eighth note, eighth rest, and quarter note. Bass clef has a quarter note, eighth note, eighth rest, and quarter note.
- Measure 12:** Treble clef has a quarter note, eighth note, eighth rest, and quarter note. Bass clef has a quarter note, eighth note, eighth rest, and quarter note.

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48-Bar Exercise



Syncopation

Syncopation Set 1

Syncopation occurs when a temporary displacement of the regular metrical accent occurs, causing the emphasis to shift from a strong accent to a weak accent.

In the examples below, each pattern (A, B and C) sounds the same, yet is written differently.

The musical notation for Syncopation Set 1 consists of 12 rows, each containing three rhythmic patterns labeled (A), (B), and (C). The patterns are written in 4/4 time, with a key signature of one flat (B-flat). The notation uses eighth and quarter notes, with accents (+) placed above the notes to indicate the metrical accent. The patterns are designed to sound the same despite being written differently.

Row 1: (A) 1 + 2 3 4 (B) 1 + 2 + 3 4 (C) 1 +2 + 3 4

Row 2: 1 2 + 3 + 4 1 2 + 3 + 4 1 2 +3 + 4

Row 3: 1 2 3 + 4 + 1 2 3 + 4 + 1 2 3 +4 +

Row 4: 1 + 2 + 3 + 4 + 1 + 2 + 3 + 4 + 1 +2 + 3 +4 +

Row 5: 1 + 2 + 3 + 4 + 1 + 2 + 3 + 4 + 1 +2 +3 +4 +

Row 6: 1 + 2 + 3 4 1 + 2 + 3 4 1 +2 + 3 4

Row 7: 1 2 + 3 + 4 1 2 + 3 + 4 1 2 +3 + 4

Row 8: 1 2 3 + 4 + 1 2 3 + 4 + 1 2 3 +4 +

Row 9: 1 + 2 3 + 4 1 + 2 + 3 + 4 + 1 +2 + 3 +4 +

Row 10: 1 + 2 + 3 + 4 1 + 2 + 3 + 4 + 1 +2 +3 +4 +

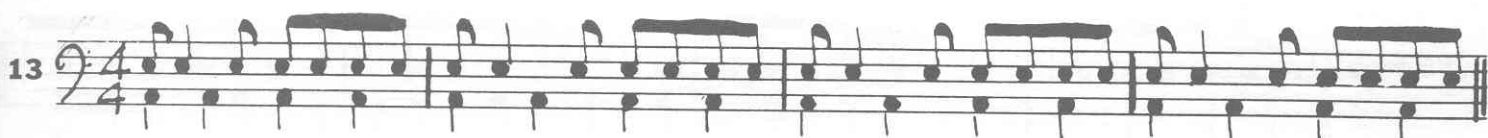
Row 11: 1 + 2 3 4 1 + 2 + 3 4 1 +2 + 3 4

Row 12: 1 2 3 + 4 1 2 3 + 4 + 1 2 3 +4 +

Syncopation Set 2

The following 48 exercises begin with the 12 rhythms found in Set 1 with new rhythms gradually introduced.

12 numbered musical exercises in 4/4 time, each consisting of a single staff with a treble clef and a key signature of one flat (Bb). The exercises are arranged in a vertical column, numbered 1 through 12. Each exercise is a 4-measure phrase. Exercise 1 is in 4/4 time. Exercises 2 through 12 are in 4/4 time. The exercises show a progression of syncopation, starting with a simple 4-measure phrase in exercise 1 and gradually introducing more complex syncopated rhythms through exercises 2 to 12. The notation includes eighth notes, quarter notes, and rests, with some exercises featuring a final measure rest.

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This musical score page contains measures 25 through 36. The notation is written on a grand staff (treble and bass clefs) in 4/4 time. The key signature has one flat (B-flat). The music features a consistent rhythmic pattern of eighth and sixteenth notes, often beamed together. Measure 25 begins with a bass clef and a 4/4 time signature. Measures 26 through 36 continue the melodic and harmonic progression, with some measures featuring more complex rhythmic groupings or ties. The page is numbered 36 in the top left corner.

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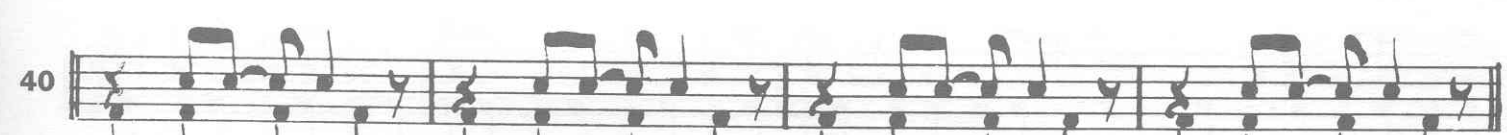
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Exercise One

Exercise One is a musical score consisting of ten staves of music, written in 4/4 time. The notation is primarily in bass clef, with a key signature of one flat (B-flat). The music is composed of eighth and sixteenth notes, often beamed together in groups, and includes various rests and accidentals. The first staff begins with a treble clef and a 4/4 time signature. The subsequent staves continue the melodic and harmonic development, with some staves featuring more complex rhythmic patterns and accidentals. The piece concludes with a double bar line on the final staff.

Exercise Two



Exercise Three

A handwritten musical score for the song "The Rose Tree". The score is written on ten staves, with the first staff featuring a treble clef and a 4/4 time signature. The music is composed of eighth and sixteenth notes, often beamed together in groups, and includes various rests. The notation is in black ink on aged, slightly yellowed paper. The melody is primarily in the treble staff, while the bass staff provides a harmonic accompaniment. The piece concludes with a final double bar line on the tenth staff.

Exercise Four

This musical exercise is written for ten staves in 4/4 time. The notation is as follows:

- Staff 1:** Bass clef, 4/4 time signature. Measures 1-4: G2, A2, B2, C3 (quarter notes); D2-E2-F2-G2 (beamed eighth notes); A2-B2-C3 (beamed eighth notes); D2-E2-F2-G2 (beamed eighth notes).
- Staff 2:** Treble clef. Measures 1-4: G4, A4, B4, C5 (quarter notes); D4-E4-F4-G4 (beamed eighth notes); A4-B4-C5 (beamed eighth notes); D4-E4-F4-G4 (beamed eighth notes).
- Staff 3:** Treble clef. Measures 1-4: G4, A4, B4, C5 (quarter notes); D4-E4-F4-G4 (beamed eighth notes); A4-B4-C5 (beamed eighth notes); D4-E4-F4-G4 (beamed eighth notes).
- Staff 4:** Treble clef. Measures 1-4: G4, A4, B4, C5 (quarter notes); D4-E4-F4-G4 (beamed eighth notes); A4-B4-C5 (beamed eighth notes); D4-E4-F4-G4 (beamed eighth notes).
- Staff 5:** Treble clef. Measures 1-4: G4, A4, B4, C5 (quarter notes); D4-E4-F4-G4 (beamed eighth notes); A4-B4-C5 (beamed eighth notes); D4-E4-F4-G4 (beamed eighth notes).
- Staff 6:** Treble clef. Measures 1-4: G4, A4, B4, C5 (quarter notes); D4-E4-F4-G4 (beamed eighth notes); A4-B4-C5 (beamed eighth notes); D4-E4-F4-G4 (beamed eighth notes).
- Staff 7:** Treble clef. Measures 1-4: G4, A4, B4, C5 (quarter notes); D4-E4-F4-G4 (beamed eighth notes); A4-B4-C5 (beamed eighth notes); D4-E4-F4-G4 (beamed eighth notes).
- Staff 8:** Treble clef. Measures 1-4: G4, A4, B4, C5 (quarter notes); D4-E4-F4-G4 (beamed eighth notes); A4-B4-C5 (beamed eighth notes); D4-E4-F4-G4 (beamed eighth notes).
- Staff 9:** Treble clef. Measures 1-4: G4, A4, B4, C5 (quarter notes); D4-E4-F4-G4 (beamed eighth notes); A4-B4-C5 (beamed eighth notes); D4-E4-F4-G4 (beamed eighth notes).
- Staff 10:** Treble clef. Measures 1-4: G4, A4, B4, C5 (quarter notes); D4-E4-F4-G4 (beamed eighth notes); A4-B4-C5 (beamed eighth notes); D4-E4-F4-G4 (beamed eighth notes).

Exercise Five

Exercise Five is a musical score consisting of ten staves of music. The music is written in 4/4 time, as indicated by the time signature at the beginning of the first staff. The notation is primarily in bass clef, with a key signature of one flat (B-flat). The score is organized into four systems, each containing two staves. The first staff of each system begins with a treble clef and a key signature of one flat, while the subsequent staves in the system are in bass clef. The music features a variety of rhythmic patterns, including eighth notes, quarter notes, and half notes, often grouped in beamed pairs or triplets. The overall structure is a continuous piece of music, with the final staff ending with a double bar line.

Exercise Six

This musical exercise is written for a single melodic line on a single staff, using a bass clef and a 4/4 time signature. The piece consists of ten measures of music. The notation includes a variety of rhythmic values: quarter notes, eighth notes, and sixteenth notes, often grouped together in beams. There are also rests and ties used throughout the piece. The key signature is one flat (B-flat), indicated by a flat symbol on the first line of the staff. The exercise is designed to practice rhythmic accuracy and melodic flow.

Exercise Seven

This musical score, titled "Exercise Seven", is written for a single melodic line on a single staff. The time signature is 7/8, indicated by a '7' over a 'C' (common time) at the beginning. The key signature is one flat (B-flat), indicated by a flat symbol on the B line. The score consists of ten staves of music, each containing four measures. The notation includes various rhythmic values: eighth notes, quarter notes, and half notes, often beamed together in groups. The exercise is characterized by a consistent eighth-note pulse in the right hand, with the left hand providing harmonic support through chords and single notes. The final measure of the tenth staff concludes with a double bar line and repeat dots.

Exercise Eight

This musical exercise is written for a single melodic line on a grand staff (treble and bass clef). The time signature is 4/4. The piece consists of 12 staves of music, each containing four measures. The notation includes a variety of rhythmic patterns such as eighth notes, sixteenth notes, and quarter notes, often beamed together. There are also frequent rests, particularly on the off-beats. The exercise is designed to develop rhythmic precision and melodic fluency.

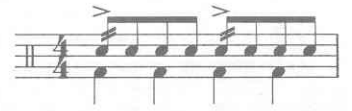
Exercise Nine

Exercise Nine is a musical score consisting of 12 staves of music. The time signature is 4/4. The music is written in a single melodic line on a five-line staff. The notation includes various rhythmic values, including eighth and sixteenth notes, and rests. There are several triplet markings (indicated by a '3' over a group of notes) and accents (indicated by a '>' symbol). The piece concludes with a double bar line and repeat dots.

Lesson One

Accented eighth notes.

For variety, the *accented notes* on pages 47–63 may be played on the small tom-tom, large tom-tom, cymbals, etc. They may also be used for accented roll studies by buzzing each note. For example:



12 rows of musical notation, each containing 12 measures of accented eighth notes. The notation is arranged in a grid, with each row numbered 1 through 12 on the left. Each measure contains a pair of eighth notes with an accent mark (^) above the first note. The notes are on the lines and spaces of the staff, representing a specific rhythmic pattern.

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This image shows a musical score for 12 staves, numbered 13 through 24. Each staff contains a sequence of musical notes, primarily eighth and sixteenth notes, often grouped in pairs or fours with a '2' above them, indicating a specific rhythmic pattern. The notes are written on a five-line staff with a treble clef. The background is white, and the notation is in black ink.

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28-Bar Exercise



The 28-Bar Exercise consists of seven staves of music. Each staff begins with a treble clef and a 4/4 time signature. The melody is composed of eighth notes, many of which are beamed in pairs and marked with an accent (>). The bass line consists of quarter notes, primarily on the lower staff of each system. The exercise concludes with a double bar line and a final note on the seventh staff.

Lesson Two

Accented dotted-eighth/sixteenth notes.

11 staves of musical notation, each containing four measures of music. The notation features accented dotted-eighth/sixteenth notes, indicated by a small 'v' above the note head. The staves are numbered 1 through 11 on the left.

This page contains a musical score for 12 staves, numbered 12 to 23. Each staff is a system of two staves (treble and bass clef). The notation consists of eighth and sixteenth notes, often beamed together in groups of four or eight. There are many accents (marked with a 'v' or similar symbol) above many of the notes. The music is written in a single key and time signature, which is not explicitly shown but appears to be common time or 4/4. The staves are numbered 12 through 23 on the left side. The notation is consistent across all staves, suggesting a repetitive or continuous piece of music.

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This block contains the musical notation for measures 24 through 28 of a 28-Bar Exercise. Each measure is represented by a single staff. The notation consists of a series of eighth notes, each with an accent (>) above it, grouped in pairs. The notes are written on a five-line staff with a key signature of one flat (B-flat) and a common time signature (C). The rhythm is consistent across all measures, with each measure containing four groups of two eighth notes.

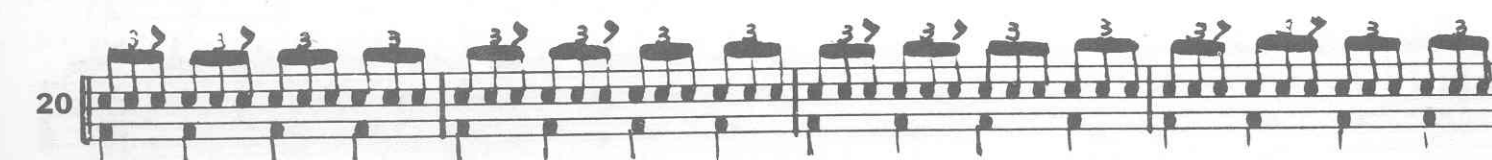
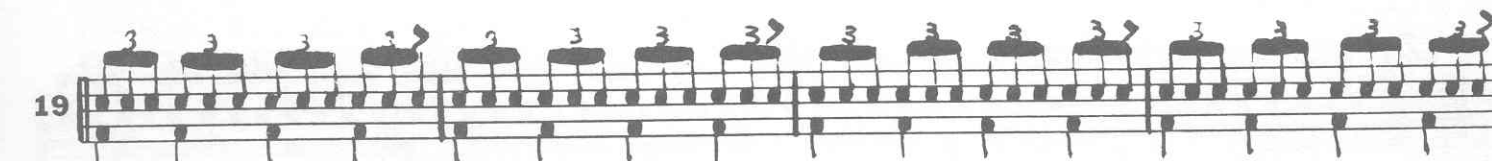
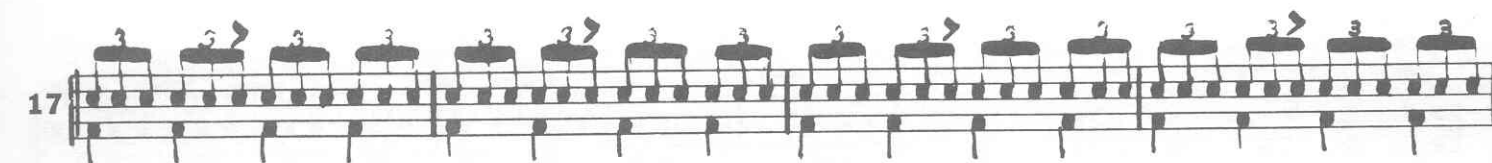
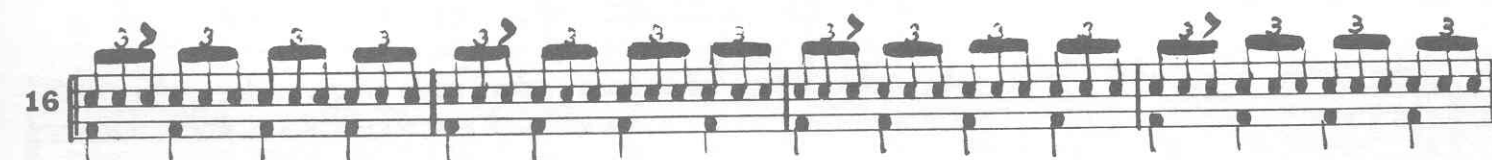
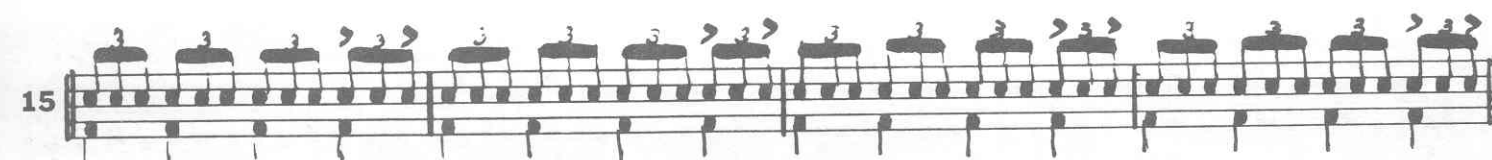
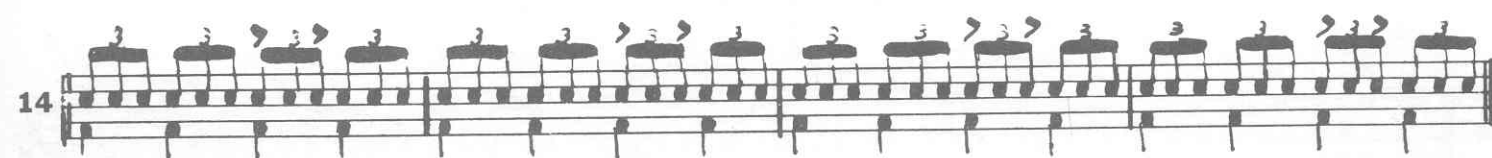
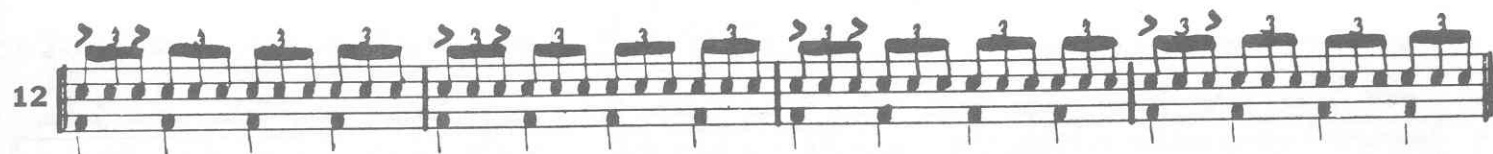
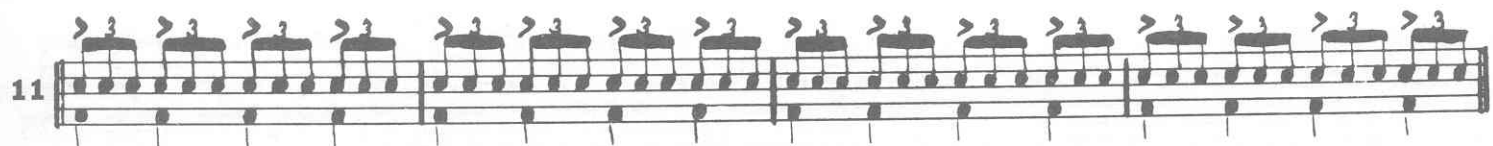
28-Bar Exercise

This block contains the musical notation for the 28-Bar Exercise. The exercise is written on seven staves, each representing a measure. The notation consists of a series of eighth notes, each with an accent (>) above it, grouped in pairs. The notes are written on a five-line staff with a key signature of one flat (B-flat) and a common time signature (C). The rhythm is consistent across all measures, with each measure containing four groups of two eighth notes. The exercise concludes with a double bar line and a repeat sign at the end of the seventh staff.

Lesson Three

Accented eighth-note triplets.

This page contains ten staves of musical notation, numbered 1 through 10. Each staff is in 4/4 time and features a series of accented eighth-note triplets. The triplets are written as eighth notes with a '3' above them and an accent (>) over the first note. The bass line of each staff consists of quarter notes. The patterns of triplets vary across the staves, including eighth-note triplets, sixteenth-note triplets, and triplet eighth notes. The notation is presented in a clear, black-and-white format suitable for a music textbook.



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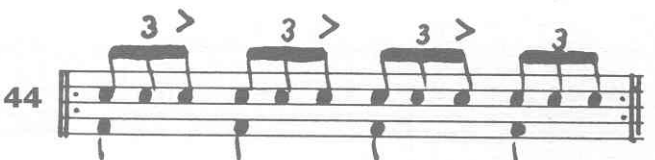
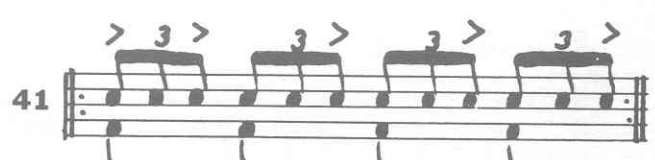
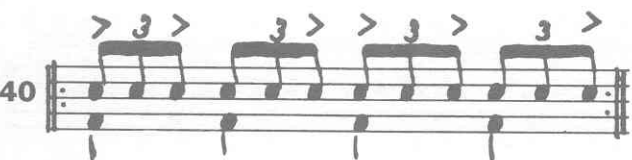
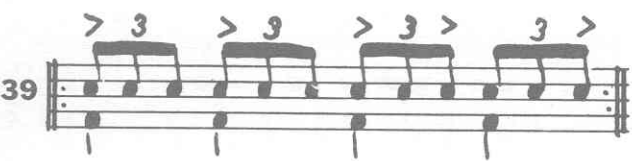
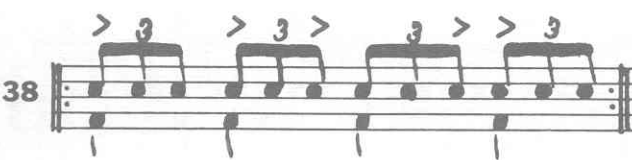
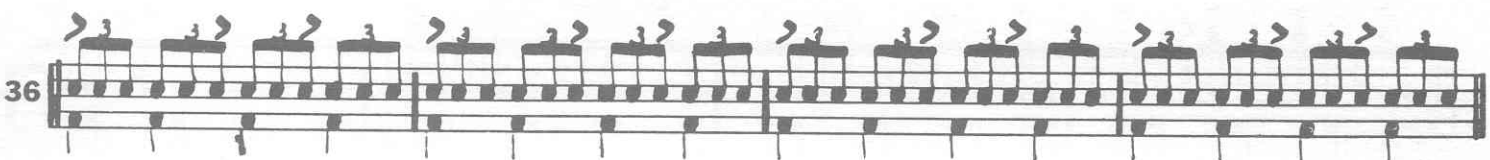
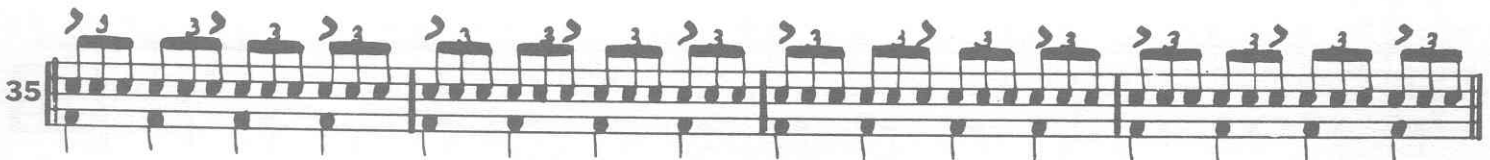
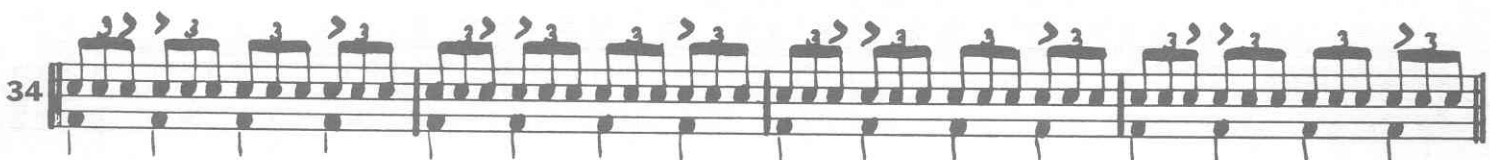
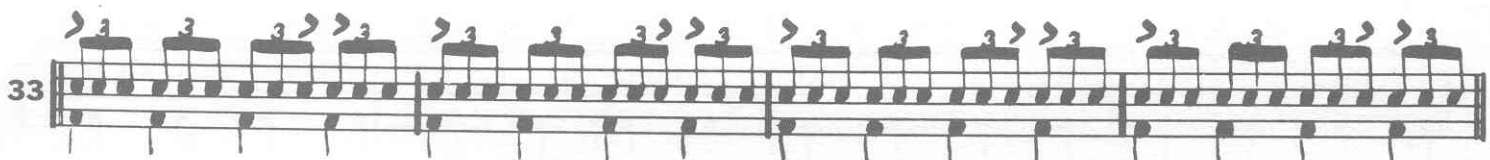
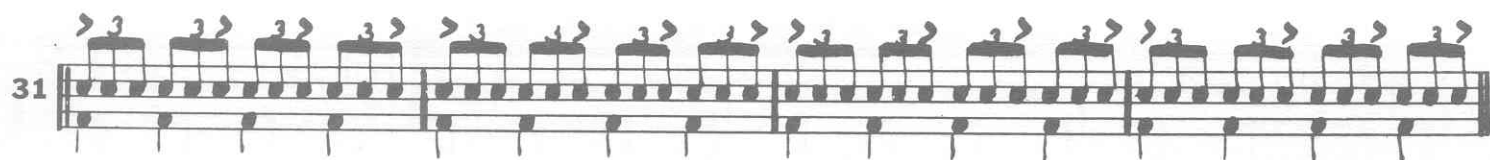
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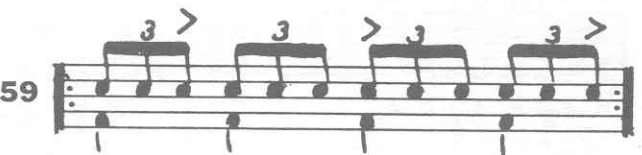
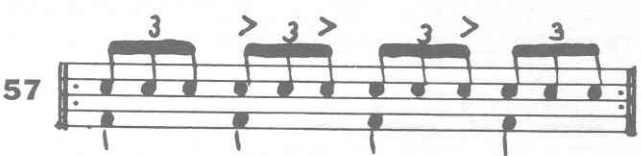
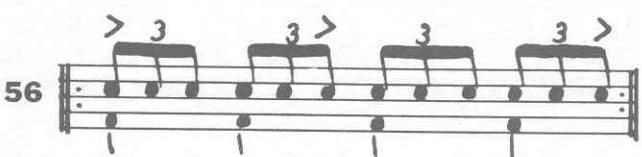
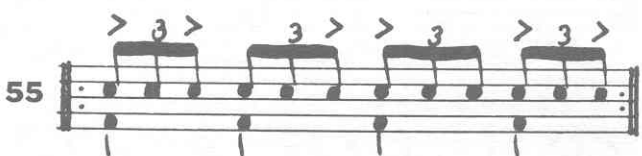
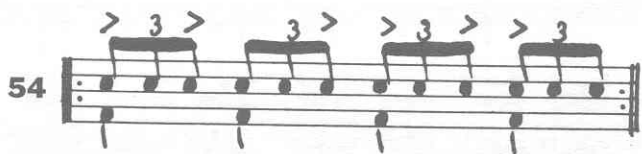
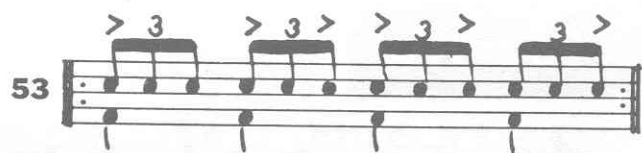
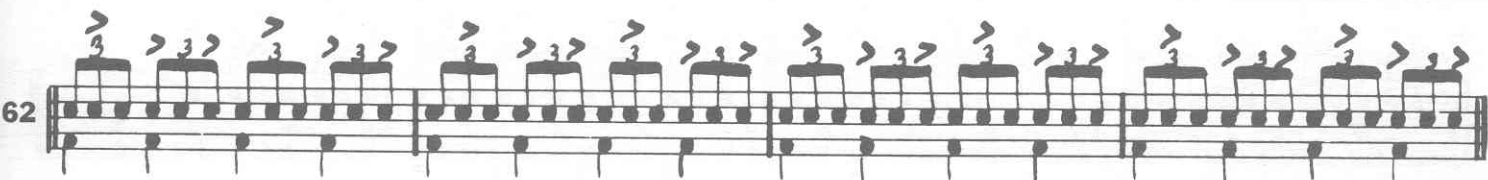
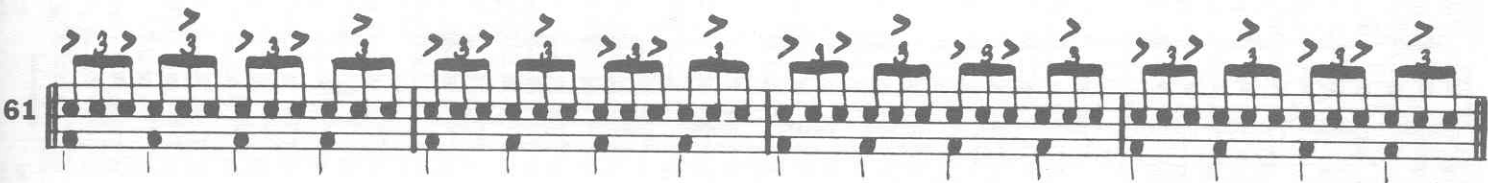
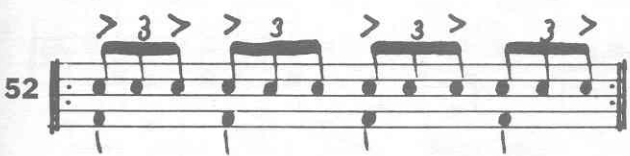
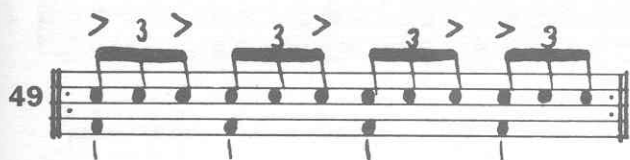
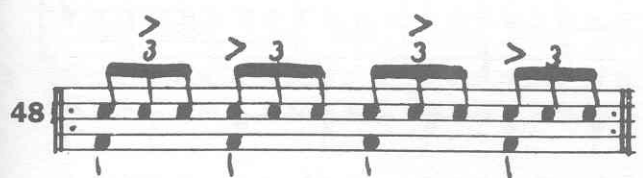
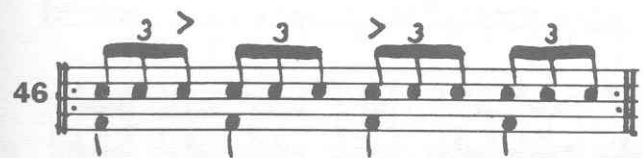
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The image displays ten staves of musical notation, numbered 21 through 30. Each staff contains a sequence of eighth notes with various rhythmic markings (accents, slurs, and triplets) above them. The notation is arranged in a single column, with each staff starting on a new line. The notes are primarily eighth notes, and the markings indicate complex rhythmic patterns. The staves are numbered 21 through 30 on the left side.





36-Bar Exercise

This musical exercise is written in 2/4 time and consists of 36 bars, organized into nine systems of four bars each. The notation is as follows:

- System 1:** Four measures of eighth-note triplets. The first measure contains two triplets (e.g., G4, A4, B4 and C5, B4, A4). The subsequent measures each contain one triplet.
- System 2:** Four measures of eighth-note triplets, continuing the melodic sequence.
- System 3:** Four measures of eighth-note triplets.
- System 4:** Four measures of eighth-note triplets.
- System 5:** Four measures of eighth-note triplets.
- System 6:** Four measures of eighth-note triplets.
- System 7:** Four measures of eighth-note triplets.
- System 8:** Four measures of eighth-note triplets.
- System 9:** Four measures of eighth-note triplets, concluding the exercise.

The exercise is a technical study for eighth-note triplets and sixteenth-note patterns, focusing on rhythmic precision and finger dexterity.

Lesson Four

Triplets with mixed sticking.

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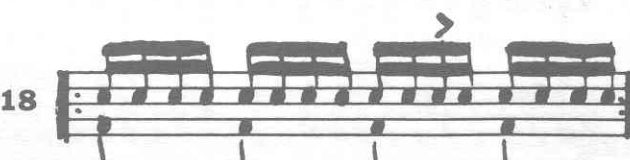
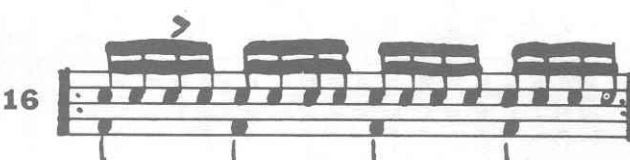
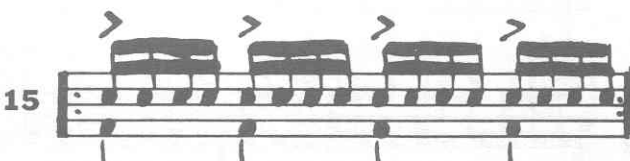
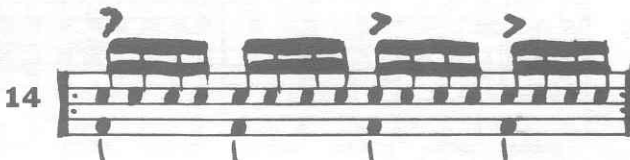
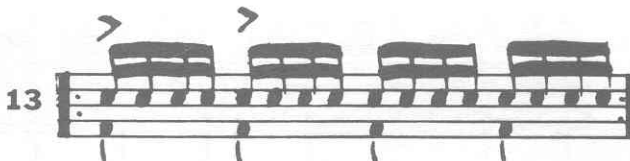
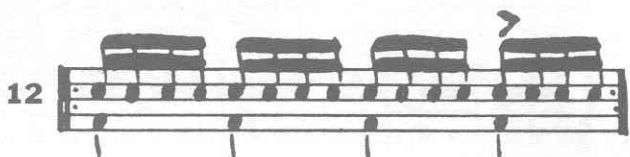
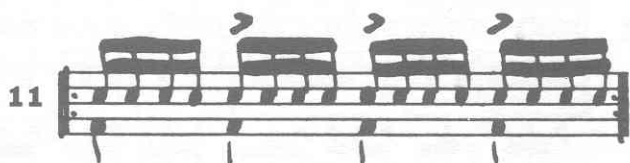
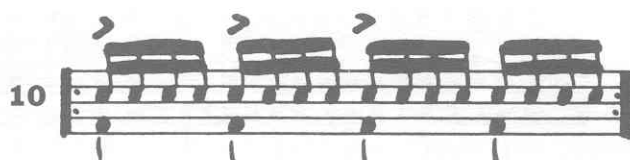
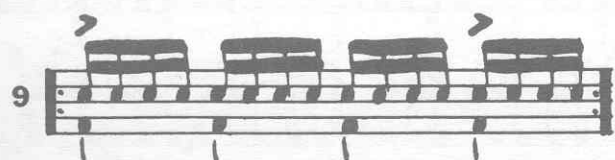
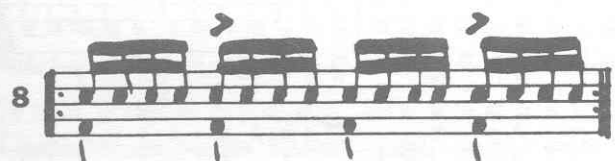
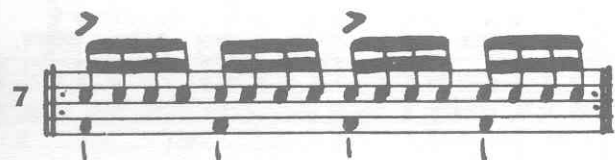
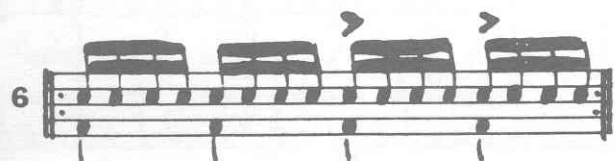
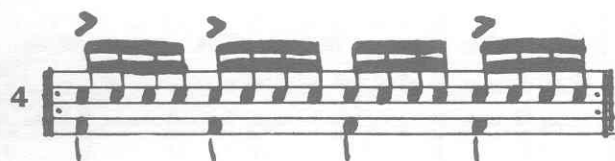
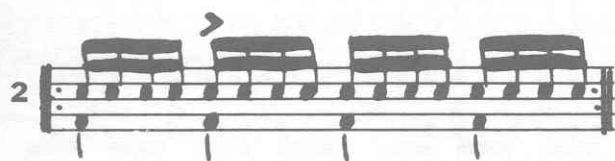
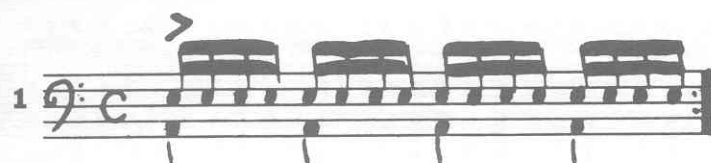
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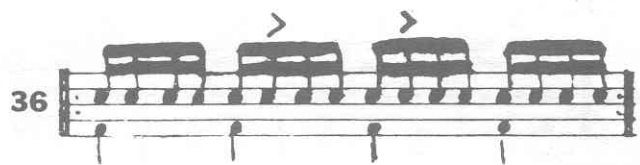
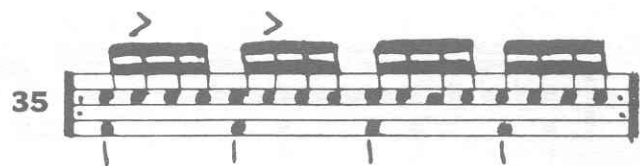
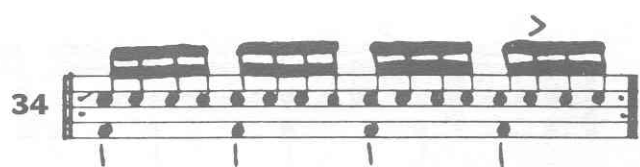
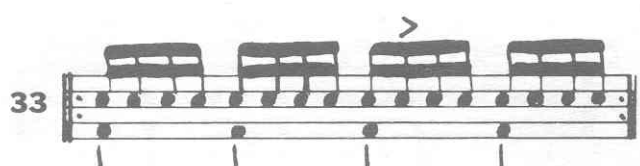
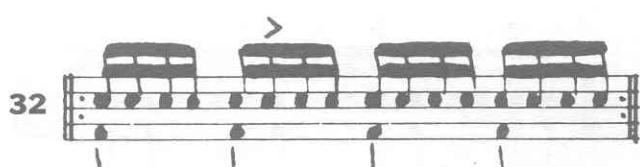
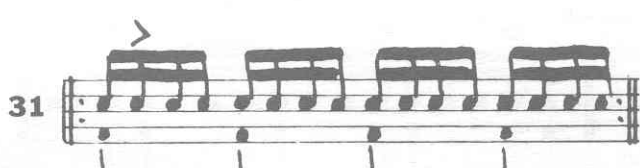
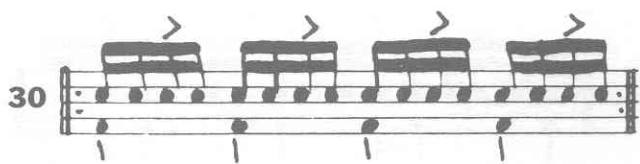
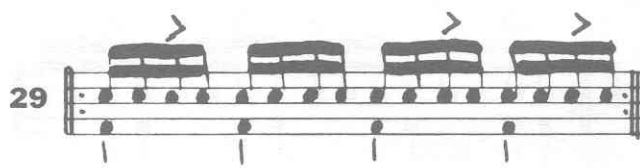
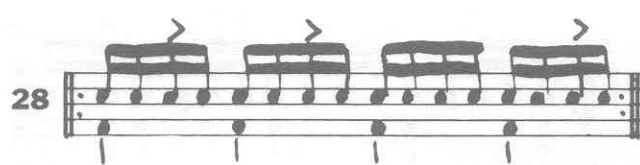
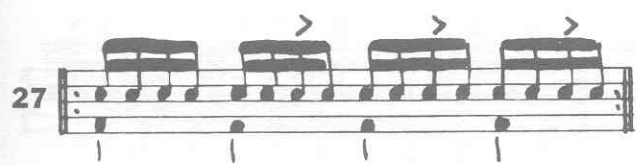
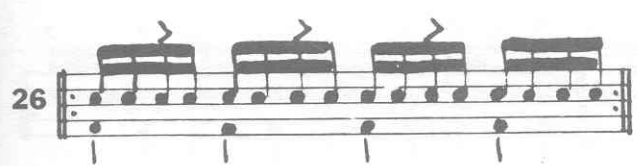
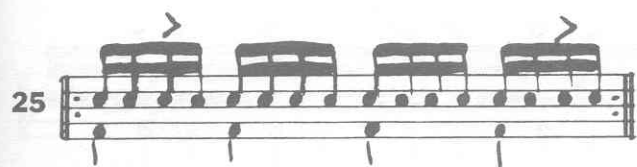
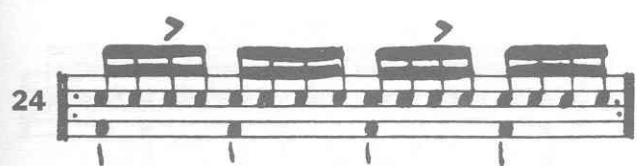
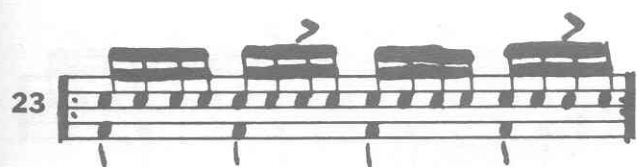
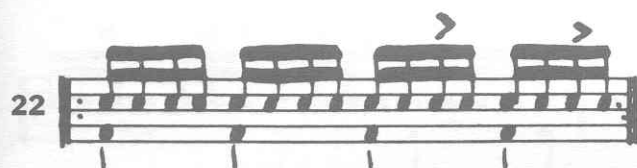
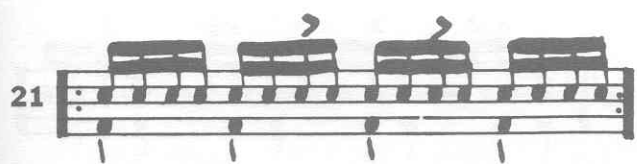
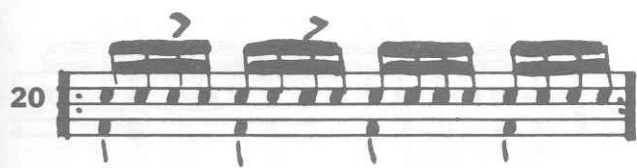
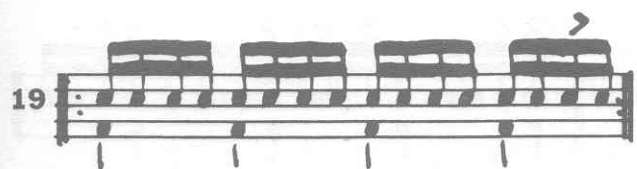
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12

Lesson Five

Accented sixteenth notes.





37

39

Exercise 39 is a short piece in 2/4 time, consisting of 8 measures. The notation is as follows:

- Measure 1: Treble staff has two eighth notes (G4, A4); Bass staff has two eighth notes (F3, E3).
- Measure 2: Treble staff has two eighth notes (B4, C5) with an accent (>) over the first; Bass staff has two eighth notes (D3, C3).
- Measure 3: Treble staff has two eighth notes (D5, E5); Bass staff has two eighth notes (B2, A2).
- Measure 4: Treble staff has two eighth notes (F5, E5) with an accent (>) over the first; Bass staff has two eighth notes (G2, F2).
- Measure 5: Treble staff has two eighth notes (D5, C5); Bass staff has two eighth notes (E2, D2).
- Measure 6: Treble staff has two eighth notes (B4, A4); Bass staff has two eighth notes (C2, B1).
- Measure 7: Treble staff has two eighth notes (G4, F4); Bass staff has two eighth notes (A1, G1).
- Measure 8: Treble staff has two eighth notes (E4, D4); Bass staff has two eighth notes (F1, E1).

41

42

Musical notation for exercise 42, featuring four measures of music. Each measure contains a pair of eighth notes beamed together, with an accent (>) above the first note. The notes are on a five-line staff.

43 

44



45 

46

47 

49

51

Musical notation for exercise 51, featuring a treble clef, a key signature of one sharp (F#), and a 4/4 time signature. The melody consists of eighth notes with accents (>) and slurs. The bass line consists of quarter notes.

52

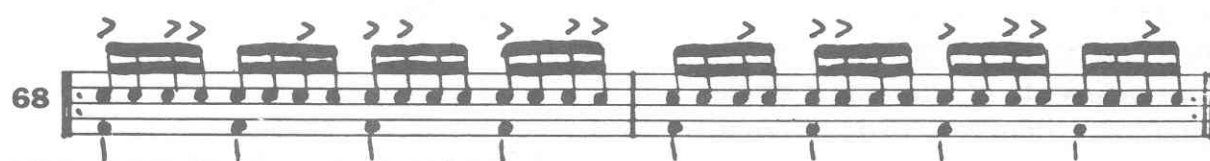
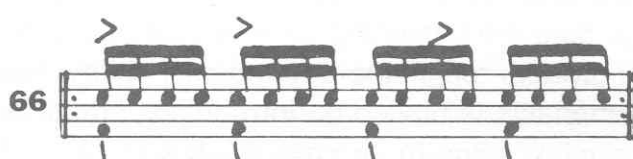
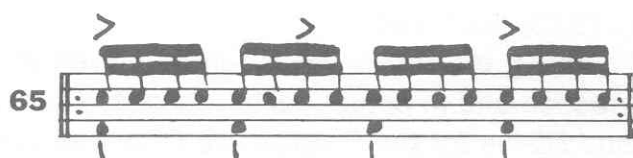
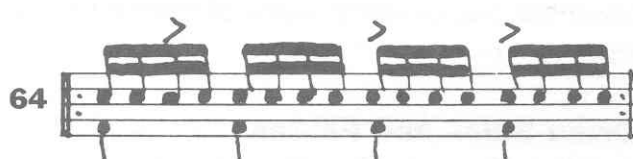
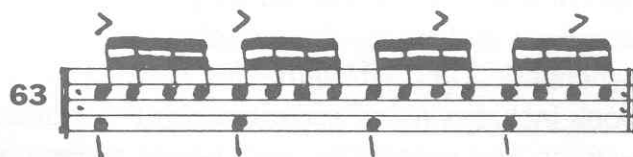
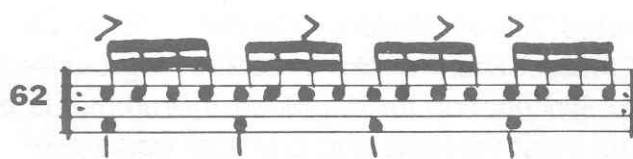
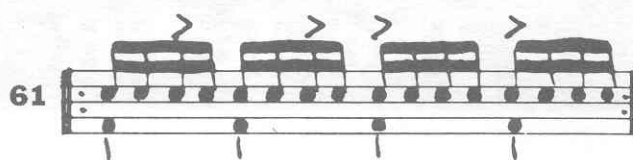
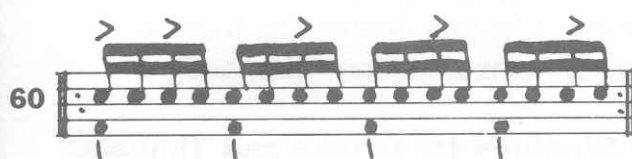
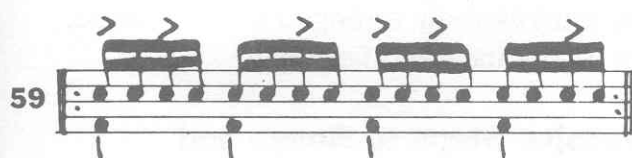
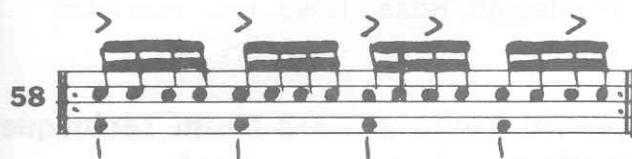
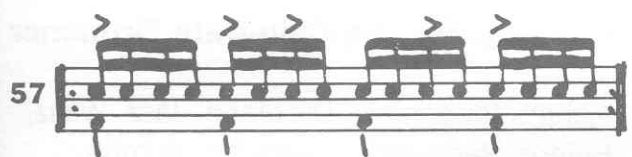
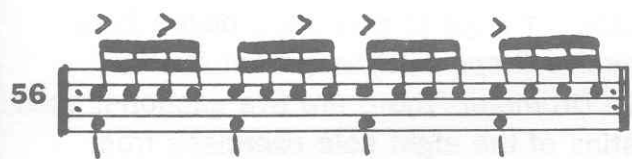
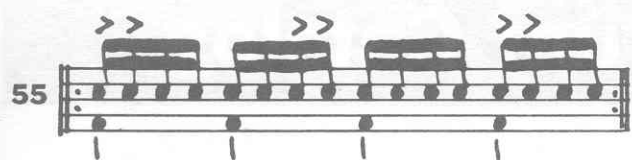
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53

Musical notation for exercise 53, featuring a treble clef, a key signature of one sharp (F#), and a 2/4 time signature. The melody consists of four measures, each containing a beamed eighth-note pair (G4, A4) followed by a quarter note (B4). Each measure is marked with an accent (>) above the first eighth note. The bass line consists of four quarter notes: G3, F#3, E3, and D3.

54

Musical notation for exercise 54. It consists of a single staff with a treble clef. The notation shows a sequence of eighth notes grouped into four pairs. Each pair is beamed together and has an accent (>) above it. The notes are: G4, A4, B4, C5, D5, E5, F5, G5, A5, B5, C6, D6, E6, F6, G6.



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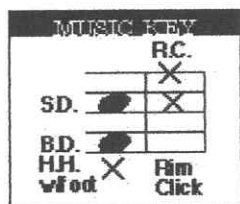
The World's Most Widely Read
Drum Magazine

August 1999
Online

Jazz Drummers' Workshop

Four-Way Coordination: As Taught By Alan Dawson

by John Ramsay



Alan Dawson had more than forty ways of interpreting the eight pages of syncopated exercises in Ted Reed's Progressive Steps To Syncopation For The Modern Drummer (pages 38-45, new version). This article offers a selection of those examples. (The first three are a prerequisite for learning the rest.)

While playing these exercises, it's important that you do not stop or go back if you make a mistake; Alan was adamant about this. Rather, try to make a mental note of where the mistakes occurred, go back after you've completed the page, isolate the measure or measures, and then play them repeatedly. First, play the measure alone, and then as a repeated two- or four-bar phrase. This approach is essential for establishing good reading habits.

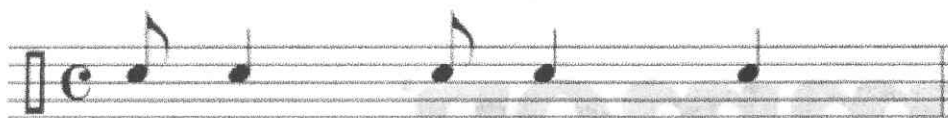
Following are ten ways Alan used Ted Reed's book. Each approach is demonstrated using one or two examples from the book. Spend at least a week on each approach, using the entire syncopation section of the Reed book, before moving on to the next approach.

1. Snare Drum Plays The Line

In this approach, the left hand plays the syncopated line on the snare, the right hand plays jazz time, the bass drum "feathers" (plays lightly) quarter notes, and the hi-hat plays beats

2 and 4.

Written:



Played:



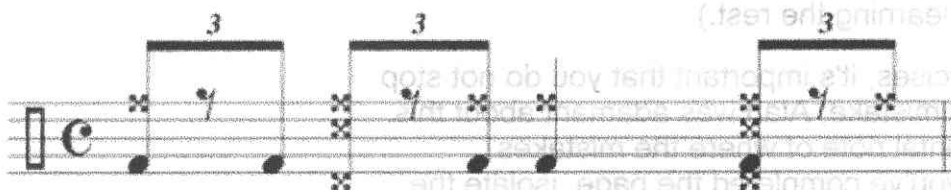
2. Bass Drum Plays The Line

This time the bass drum plays the melody line, the right hand plays time, the left plays rimclicks on beats 2 and 4, and the hi-hat plays 2 and 4.

Written:



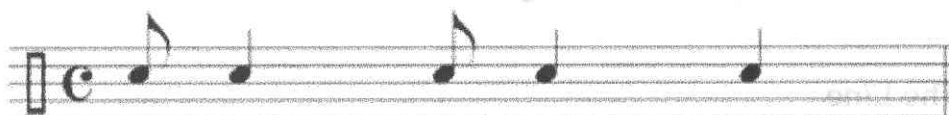
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3. Short And Long

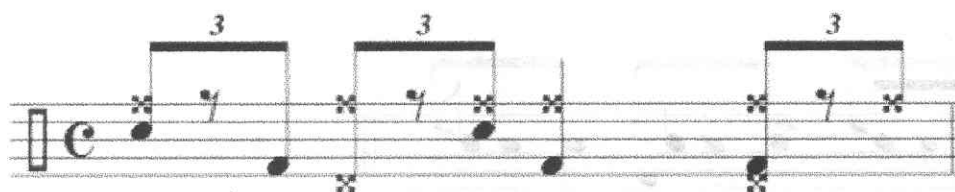
In this approach the short notes (8ths) are played on the snare, and the long notes (tied 8ths, quarters, dotted quarters) are played on the bass drum. Play jazz time on the ride cymbal with your right hand and 2 and 4 on the hi-hat.

Written:



Played:

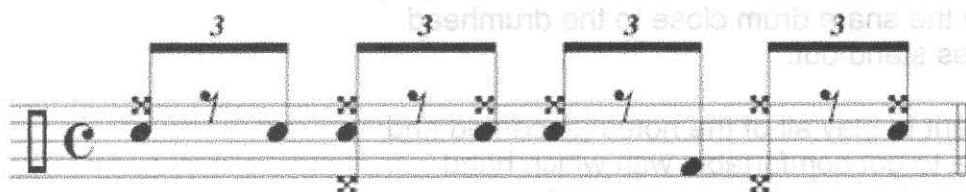
In this approach, the left hand plays the syncopated line on the snare, the right hand plays jazz time, the bass drum plays eighth notes, and the hi-hat plays beats



Written (consecutive 8ths example):



Played:



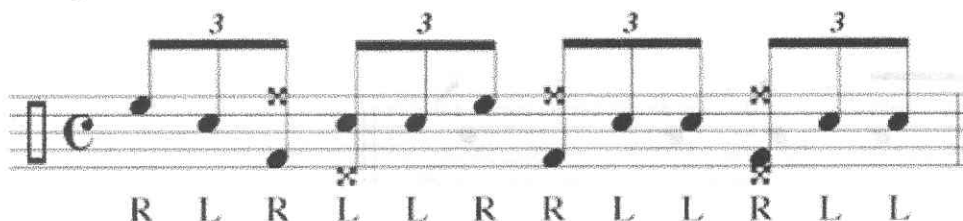
4. Left Hand Fills In Triplets

This is the first of several exercises that use the idea of filling in triplets. In this example the short notes are played by the right hand on the small tom, and the long notes are played on the cymbal (by the right hand) and the bass drum in unison. The left hand fills in triplets on the snare drum and the hi-hat plays on 2 and 4.

Written:



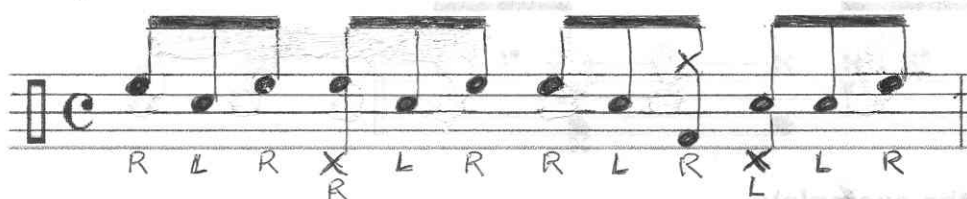
Played:



Written (consecutive 8ths example):



Played:



5. Alternating Triplets

With this approach, the sticking remains constant: alternating RLRLRL. The short notes are accented on the snare drum, the long notes are on the cymbals/bass drum, with the hi-hat again on 2 and 4. The key to making this one sound good lies in playing the unaccented notes on the snare drum close to the drumhead so that the accented notes stand out.

Practice tip: You may want to play all of the notes (accented and unaccented) on the snare to get comfortable with which hand they fall on; then follow the short and long assignments.

Written:



Played:



Written (consecutive 8ths example):



Played:

5. Bass Drum Plays The Line, Left Hand Fills In
In this example the bass drum plays the melody line and the left hand fills in triplets on the snare drum. The right hand plays the jazz ride pattern on the cymbal and the hi-hat keeps the snare drum pattern to get a good blend among all the voices of the drumset.
Written:

R L R L R L R L R L R L

6. Triplet Roll

This is similar to the alternating triplets, in that the sound sources are the same. Short notes are accented on the snare drum, long notes are on the cymbals/bass drum, and the hi-hat is on 2 and 4.

Written:

Played:

R LLR LLRRL R LLRRL RRL

Written (consecutive 8ths example):

Played:

R LLR L RRL R LLR LLRRL

7. Bass Drum Plays The Line, Left Hand Fills In

In this example the bass drum plays the melody line while the left hand fills in triplets on the snare drum. The right hand plays the jazz ride pattern on the cymbal, and the hi-hat plays 2 and 4. Be sure to get a good blend among all the voices of the drumset.

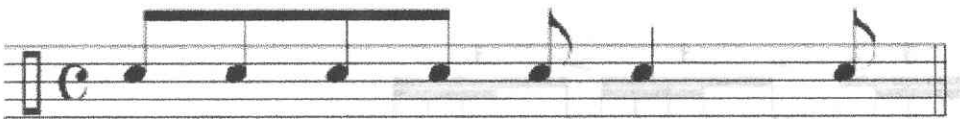
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Played:



Written (consecutive 8ths example):



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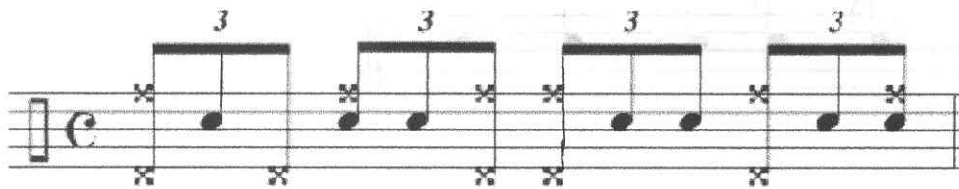
8. Hi-Hat Plays The Line, Left Hand Fills In

In this example the hi-hat (left foot) plays the melody line and the left hand fills in triplets on the snare drum. Just like in the last example, the right hand plays the ride pattern on the cymbal, but this time there's no bass drum. Be sure to get a good blend between the hi-hat and the snare drum; keep the snare drum strokes low and the notes soft.

Written:



Played:



Written (consecutive 8ths example):



Played:



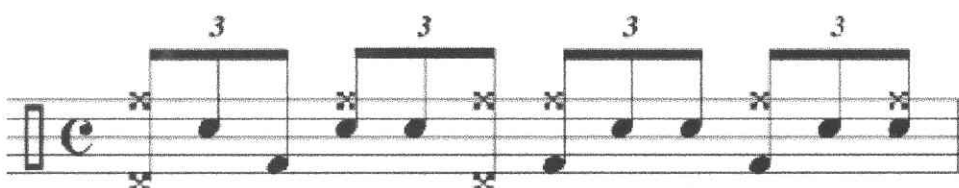
9. Hi-Hat Short, Bass Drum Long, Left Hand Fills

In this example, the hi-hat plays the short notes while the bass drum plays the long notes. The left hand fills in triplets on the snare drum, and the right hand plays the jazz ride pattern. This example is truly a four-way coordination challenge. Be sure to get a good blend of all the parts. You should be able to clearly hear the melody line.

Written:



Played:



Written (consecutive 8ths example):

Played:



Played:



10. Snare Drum Plays The Line, Bass Drum Fills In

This exercise is another challenge. The snare drum plays the melody line, the right hand plays time, the hi-hat plays 2 and 4, and the bass drum fills in triplets (the way the left hand does with exercise 1). I suggest using heel-down technique in order to more easily allow the beater to rebound.

Written:



Played:



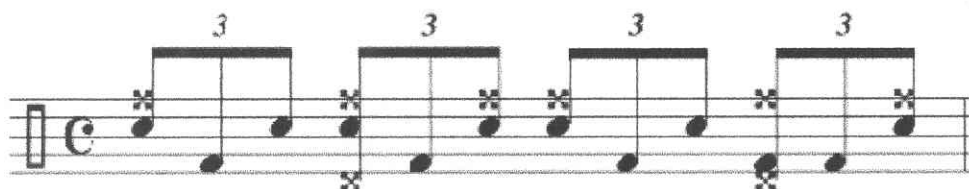
Written (consecutive 8ths example):



Played:



Written (consecutive 8ths example):



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11. $\frac{3}{4}$ And 3 on Bass Drum, 2 and 4 on Snare Drum